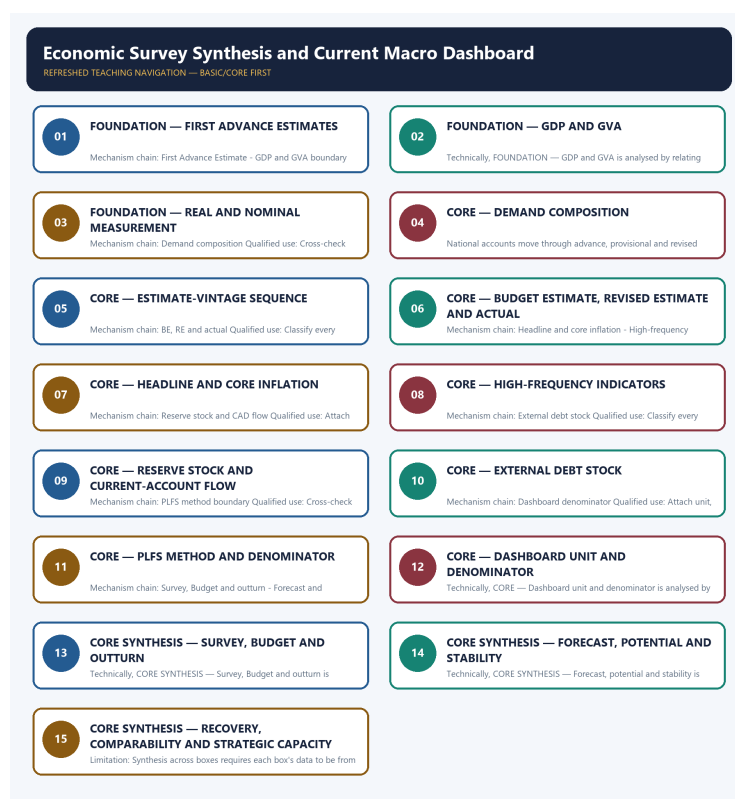


SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Economic Survey Synthesis and Current Macro Dashboard - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Authoring-only generation: 2026-09-03. Uses the same source-bounded Economy distinctions and strict A-B-C-D rotation.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies First Advance Estimate?

A. A First Advance Estimate is released before complete annual data and is revised as fuller information arrives; it is neither a final audited outcome nor a timeless current fact. B. GDP at market prices and GVA at basic prices answer related but distinct questions, so tax and subsidy effects can make their growth rates differ without contradiction. C. Real aggregates remove price change using a stated base and method, while nominal aggregates value output at current prices; a real growth rate cannot be compared directly with a nominal level. D. PFCE, government consumption, gross capital formation and net exports describe expenditure composition; a component's share of GDP and its growth rate are different measures.

Answer: A. Explanation: A First Advance Estimate is released before complete annual data and is revised as fuller information arrives; it is neither a final audited outcome nor a timeless current fact. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q2. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of First Advance Estimate?

A. Real aggregates remove price change using a stated base and method, while nominal aggregates value output at current prices; a real growth rate cannot be compared directly with a nominal level. B. A First Advance Estimate is released before complete annual data and is revised as fuller information arrives; it is neither a final audited outcome nor a timeless current fact. C. PFCE, government consumption, gross capital formation and net exports describe expenditure composition; a component's share of GDP and its growth rate are different measures. D. National accounts move through advance, provisional and revised estimates as data improve; every quoted figure must retain the release date and estimate vintage used by the source.

Answer: B. Explanation: A First Advance Estimate is released before complete annual data and is revised as fuller information arrives; it is neither a final audited outcome nor a timeless current fact. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q3. Which statement uses First Advance Estimate without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. PFCE, government consumption, gross capital formation and net exports describe expenditure composition; a component's share of GDP and its growth rate are different measures. B. National accounts move through advance, provisional and revised estimates as data improve; every quoted figure must retain the release date and estimate vintage used by the source. C. A First Advance Estimate is released before complete annual data and is revised as fuller information arrives; it is neither a final audited outcome nor a timeless current fact. D. Budget Estimate is a forward plan, Revised Estimate is an in-year reassessment and CGA provisional or final accounts report realised fiscal flows; proposal, revision and outturn are not interchangeable.

Answer: C. Explanation: A First Advance Estimate is released before complete annual data and is revised as fuller information arrives; it is neither a final audited outcome nor a timeless current fact. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q4. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about First Advance Estimate?

A. National accounts move through advance, provisional and revised estimates as data improve; every quoted figure must retain the release date and estimate vintage used by the source. B. Budget Estimate is a forward plan, Revised Estimate is an in-year reassessment and CGA provisional or final accounts report realised fiscal flows; proposal, revision and outturn are not interchangeable. C. Headline CPI includes food and fuel while core measures exclude selected volatile components; low headline inflation does not mean every component or household basket became cheaper. D. A First Advance Estimate is released before complete annual data and is revised as fuller information arrives; it is neither a final audited outcome nor a timeless current fact.

Answer: D. Explanation: A First Advance Estimate is released before complete annual data and is revised as fuller information arrives; it is neither a final audited outcome nor a timeless current fact. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies GDP and GVA boundary?

A. GDP at market prices and GVA at basic prices answer related but distinct questions, so tax and subsidy effects can make their growth rates differ without contradiction. B. Real aggregates remove price change using a stated base and method, while nominal aggregates value output at current prices; a real growth rate cannot be compared directly with a nominal level. C. PFCE, government consumption, gross capital formation and net exports describe expenditure composition; a component's share of GDP and its growth rate are different measures. D. National accounts move through advance, provisional and revised estimates as data improve; every quoted figure must retain the release date and estimate vintage used by the source.

Answer: A. Explanation: GDP at market prices and GVA at basic prices answer related but distinct questions, so tax and subsidy effects can make their growth rates differ without contradiction. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q6. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of GDP and GVA boundary?

A. PFCE, government consumption, gross capital formation and net exports describe expenditure composition; a component's share of GDP and its growth rate are different measures. B. GDP at market prices and GVA at basic prices answer related but distinct questions, so tax and subsidy effects can make their growth rates differ without contradiction. C. National accounts move through advance, provisional and revised estimates as data improve; every quoted figure must retain the release date and estimate vintage used by the source. D. Budget Estimate is a forward plan, Revised Estimate is an in-year reassessment and CGA provisional or final accounts report realised fiscal flows; proposal, revision and outturn are not interchangeable.

Answer: B. Explanation: GDP at market prices and GVA at basic prices answer related but distinct questions, so tax and subsidy effects can make their growth rates differ without contradiction. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q7. Which statement uses GDP and GVA boundary without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. National accounts move through advance, provisional and revised estimates as data improve; every quoted figure must retain the release date and estimate vintage used by the source. B. Budget Estimate is a forward plan, Revised Estimate is an in-year reassessment and CGA provisional or final accounts report realised fiscal flows; proposal, revision and outturn are not interchangeable. C. GDP at market prices and GVA at basic prices answer related but distinct questions, so tax and subsidy effects can make their growth rates differ without contradiction. D. Headline CPI includes food and fuel while core measures exclude selected volatile components; low headline inflation does not mean every component or household basket became cheaper.

Answer: C. Explanation: GDP at market prices and GVA at basic prices answer related but distinct questions, so tax and subsidy effects can make their growth rates differ without contradiction. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q8. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about GDP and GVA boundary?

A. Budget Estimate is a forward plan, Revised Estimate is an in-year reassessment and CGA provisional or final accounts report realised fiscal flows; proposal, revision and outturn are not interchangeable. B. Headline CPI includes food and fuel while core measures exclude selected volatile components; low headline inflation does not mean every component or household basket became cheaper. C. High-frequency indicators provide timely signals before complete national accounts, but they are partial proxies whose seasonal, base and coverage effects must be checked. D. GDP at market prices and GVA at basic prices answer related but distinct questions, so tax and subsidy effects can make their growth rates differ without contradiction.

Answer: D. Explanation: GDP at market prices and GVA at basic prices answer related but distinct questions, so tax and subsidy effects can make their growth rates differ without contradiction. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Real and nominal boundary?

A. Real aggregates remove price change using a stated base and method, while nominal aggregates value output at current prices; a real growth rate cannot be compared directly with a nominal level. B. PFCE, government consumption, gross capital formation and net exports describe expenditure composition; a component's share of GDP and its growth rate are different measures. C. National accounts move through advance, provisional and revised estimates as data improve; every quoted figure must retain the release date and estimate vintage used by the source. D. Budget Estimate is a forward plan, Revised Estimate is an in-year reassessment and CGA provisional or final accounts report realised fiscal flows; proposal, revision and outturn are not interchangeable.

Answer: A. Explanation: Real aggregates remove price change using a stated base and method, while nominal aggregates value output at current prices; a real growth rate cannot be compared directly with a nominal level. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q10. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Real and nominal boundary?

A. National accounts move through advance, provisional and revised estimates as data improve; every quoted figure must retain the release date and estimate vintage used by the source. B. Real aggregates remove price change using a stated base and method, while nominal aggregates value output at current prices; a real growth rate cannot be compared directly with a nominal level. C. Budget Estimate is a forward plan, Revised Estimate is an in-year reassessment and CGA provisional or final accounts report realised fiscal flows; proposal, revision and outturn are not interchangeable. D. Headline CPI includes food and fuel while core measures exclude selected volatile components; low headline inflation does not mean every component or household basket became cheaper.

Answer: B. Explanation: Real aggregates remove price change using a stated base and method, while nominal aggregates value output at current prices; a real growth rate cannot be compared directly with a nominal level. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q11. Which statement uses Real and nominal boundary without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Budget Estimate is a forward plan, Revised Estimate is an in-year reassessment and CGA provisional or final accounts report realised fiscal flows; proposal, revision and outturn are not interchangeable. B. Headline CPI includes food and fuel while core measures exclude selected volatile components; low headline inflation does not mean every component or household basket became cheaper. C. Real aggregates remove price change using a stated base and method, while nominal aggregates value output at current prices; a real growth rate cannot be compared directly with a nominal level. D. High-frequency indicators provide timely signals before complete national accounts, but they are partial proxies whose seasonal, base and coverage effects must be checked.

Answer: C. Explanation: Real aggregates remove price change using a stated base and method, while nominal aggregates value output at current prices; a real growth rate cannot be compared directly with a nominal level. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or

legal perimeters.

Q12. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Real and nominal boundary?

A. Headline CPI includes food and fuel while core measures exclude selected volatile components; low headline inflation does not mean every component or household basket became cheaper. B. High-frequency indicators provide timely signals before complete national accounts, but they are partial proxies whose seasonal, base and coverage effects must be checked. C. Foreign-exchange reserves are a point-in-time stock, while the current-account balance is a period flow; a large stock buffer does not by itself correct a persistent flow imbalance. D. Real aggregates remove price change using a stated base and method, while nominal aggregates value output at current prices; a real growth rate cannot be compared directly with a nominal level.

Answer: D. Explanation: Real aggregates remove price change using a stated base and method, while nominal aggregates value output at current prices; a real growth rate cannot be compared directly with a nominal level. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Demand composition?

A. PFCE, government consumption, gross capital formation and net exports describe expenditure composition; a component's share of GDP and its growth rate are different measures. B. National accounts move through advance, provisional and revised estimates as data improve; every quoted figure must retain the release date and estimate vintage used by the source. C. Budget Estimate is a forward plan, Revised Estimate is an in-year reassessment and CGA provisional or final accounts report realised fiscal flows; proposal, revision and outturn are not interchangeable. D. Headline CPI includes food and fuel while core measures exclude selected volatile components; low headline inflation does not mean every component or household basket became cheaper.

Answer: A. Explanation: PFCE, government consumption, gross capital formation and net exports describe expenditure composition; a component's share of GDP and its growth rate are different measures. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q14. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Demand composition?

A. Budget Estimate is a forward plan, Revised Estimate is an in-year reassessment and CGA provisional or final accounts report realised fiscal flows; proposal, revision and outturn are not interchangeable. B. PFCE, government consumption, gross capital formation and net exports describe expenditure composition; a component's share of GDP and its growth rate are different measures. C. Headline CPI includes food and fuel while core measures exclude selected volatile components; low headline inflation does not mean every component or household basket became cheaper. D. High-frequency indicators provide timely signals before complete national accounts, but they are partial proxies whose seasonal, base and coverage effects must be checked.

Answer: B. Explanation: PFCE, government consumption, gross capital formation and net exports describe expenditure composition; a component's share of GDP and its growth rate are different measures. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q15. Which statement uses Demand composition without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Headline CPI includes food and fuel while core measures exclude selected volatile components; low headline inflation does not mean every component or household basket became cheaper. B. High-frequency indicators provide timely signals before complete national accounts, but they are partial proxies whose seasonal, base and coverage effects must be checked. C. PFCE, government consumption, gross capital formation and net exports describe expenditure composition; a component's share of GDP and its growth rate are different measures. D. Foreign-exchange reserves are a point-in-time stock, while the current-account balance is a period flow; a large stock buffer does not by itself correct a persistent flow imbalance.

Answer: C. Explanation: PFCE, government consumption, gross capital formation and net exports describe expenditure composition; a component's share of GDP and its growth rate are different measures. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q16. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Demand composition?

A. High-frequency indicators provide timely signals before complete national accounts, but they are partial proxies whose seasonal, base and coverage effects must be checked. B. Foreign-exchange reserves are a point-in-time stock, while the current-account balance is a period flow; a large stock buffer does not by itself correct a persistent flow imbalance. C. External debt is a liability stock measured at a stated date and must be assessed with maturity, currency, borrower and servicing capacity rather than confused with annual capital inflows. D. PFCE, government consumption, gross capital formation and net exports describe expenditure composition; a component's share of GDP and its growth rate are different measures.

Answer: D. Explanation: PFCE, government consumption, gross capital formation and net exports describe expenditure composition; a component's share of GDP and its growth rate are different measures. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies Estimate-vintage sequence?

A. National accounts move through advance, provisional and revised estimates as data improve; every quoted figure must retain the release date and estimate vintage used by the source. B. Budget Estimate is a forward plan, Revised Estimate is an in-year reassessment and CGA provisional or final accounts report realised fiscal flows; proposal, revision and outturn are not interchangeable. C. Headline CPI includes food and fuel while core measures exclude selected volatile components; low headline inflation does not mean every component or household basket became cheaper. D. High-frequency indicators provide timely signals before complete national accounts, but they are partial proxies whose seasonal, base and coverage effects must be checked.

Answer: A. Explanation: National accounts move through advance, provisional and revised estimates as data improve; every quoted figure must retain the release date and estimate vintage used by the source. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q18. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Estimate-vintage sequence?

A. Headline CPI includes food and fuel while core measures exclude selected volatile components; low headline inflation does not mean every component or household basket became cheaper. B. National accounts move through advance, provisional and revised estimates as data improve; every quoted figure must retain the release date and estimate vintage used by the source. C. High-frequency indicators provide timely signals before complete national accounts, but they are partial proxies whose seasonal, base and coverage effects must be checked. D. Foreign-exchange reserves are a point-in-time stock, while the current-account balance is a period flow; a large stock buffer does not by itself correct a persistent flow imbalance.

Answer: B. Explanation: National accounts move through advance, provisional and revised estimates as data improve; every quoted figure must retain the release date and estimate vintage used by the source. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q19. Which statement uses Estimate-vintage sequence without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. High-frequency indicators provide timely signals before complete national accounts, but they are partial proxies whose seasonal, base and coverage effects must be checked. B. Foreign-exchange reserves are a point-in-time stock, while the current-account balance is a period flow; a large stock buffer does not by itself correct a persistent flow imbalance. C. National accounts move through advance, provisional and revised estimates as data improve; every quoted figure must retain the release date and estimate vintage used by the source. D. External debt is a liability stock measured at a stated date and must be assessed with maturity, currency, borrower and servicing capacity rather than confused with annual capital inflows.

Answer: C. Explanation: National accounts move through advance, provisional and revised estimates as data improve; every quoted figure must retain the release date and estimate vintage used by the source. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q20. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Estimate-vintage sequence?

A. Foreign-exchange reserves are a point-in-time stock, while the current-account balance is a period flow; a large stock buffer does not by itself correct a persistent flow imbalance. B. External debt is a liability stock measured at a stated date and must be assessed with maturity, currency, borrower and servicing capacity rather than confused with annual capital inflows. C. PLFS labour indicators depend on period, geography and status concept such as usual status or current weekly status; one rate without its denominator and method is incomplete. D. National accounts move through advance, provisional and revised estimates as data improve; every quoted figure must retain the release date and estimate vintage used by the source.

Answer: D. Explanation: National accounts move through advance, provisional and revised estimates as data improve; every quoted figure must retain the release date and estimate vintage used by the source. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies BE, RE and actual?

A. Budget Estimate is a forward plan, Revised Estimate is an in-year reassessment and CGA provisional or final accounts report realised fiscal flows; proposal, revision and outturn are not interchangeable. B. Headline CPI includes food and fuel while core measures exclude selected volatile components; low headline inflation does not mean every component or household basket became cheaper. C. High-frequency indicators provide timely signals before complete national accounts, but they are partial proxies whose seasonal, base and coverage effects must be checked. D. Foreign-exchange reserves are a point-in-time stock, while the current-account balance is a period flow; a large stock buffer does not by itself correct a persistent flow imbalance.

Answer: A. Explanation: Budget Estimate is a forward plan, Revised Estimate is an in-year reassessment and CGA provisional or final accounts report realised fiscal flows; proposal, revision and outturn are not interchangeable. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q22. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of BE, RE and actual?

A. High-frequency indicators provide timely signals before complete national accounts, but they are partial proxies whose seasonal, base and coverage effects must be checked. B. Budget Estimate is a forward plan, Revised Estimate is an in-year reassessment and CGA provisional or final accounts report realised fiscal flows; proposal, revision and outturn are not interchangeable. C. Foreign-exchange reserves are a point-in-time stock, while the current-account balance is a period flow; a large stock buffer does not by itself correct a persistent flow imbalance. D. External debt is a liability stock measured at a stated date and must be assessed with maturity, currency, borrower and servicing capacity rather than confused with annual capital inflows.

Answer: B. Explanation: Budget Estimate is a forward plan, Revised Estimate is an in-year reassessment and CGA provisional or final accounts report realised fiscal flows; proposal, revision and outturn are not interchangeable. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q23. Which statement uses BE, RE and actual without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Foreign-exchange reserves are a point-in-time stock, while the current-account balance is a period flow; a large stock buffer does not by itself correct a persistent flow imbalance. B. External debt is a liability stock measured at a stated date and must be assessed with maturity, currency, borrower and servicing capacity rather than confused with annual capital inflows. C. Budget Estimate is a forward plan, Revised Estimate is an in-year reassessment and CGA provisional or final accounts report realised fiscal flows; proposal, revision and outturn are not interchangeable. D. PLFS labour indicators depend on period, geography and status concept such as usual status or current weekly status; one rate without its denominator and method is incomplete.

Answer: C. Explanation: Budget Estimate is a forward plan, Revised Estimate is an in-year reassessment and CGA provisional or final accounts report realised fiscal flows; proposal, revision and outturn are not interchangeable. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q24. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about BE, RE and actual?

A. External debt is a liability stock measured at a stated date and must be assessed with maturity, currency, borrower and servicing capacity rather than confused with annual capital inflows. B. PLFS labour indicators depend on period, geography and status concept such as usual status or current weekly status; one rate without its denominator and method is incomplete. C. A dashboard indicator must preserve whether it is a level, growth rate, ratio, share, index, stock, flow or per-capita measure and identify the denominator before comparison. D. Budget Estimate is a forward plan, Revised Estimate is an in-year reassessment and CGA provisional or final accounts report realised fiscal flows; proposal, revision and outturn are not interchangeable.

Answer: D. Explanation: Budget Estimate is a forward plan, Revised Estimate is an in-year reassessment and CGA provisional or final accounts report realised fiscal flows; proposal, revision and outturn are not interchangeable. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Headline and core inflation?

A. Headline CPI includes food and fuel while core measures exclude selected volatile components; low headline inflation does not mean every component or household basket became cheaper. B. High-frequency indicators provide timely signals before complete national accounts, but they are partial proxies whose seasonal, base and coverage effects must be checked. C. Foreign-exchange reserves are a point-in-time stock, while the current-account balance is a period flow; a large stock buffer does not by itself correct a persistent flow imbalance. D. External debt is a liability stock measured at a stated date and must be assessed with maturity, currency, borrower and servicing capacity rather than confused with annual capital inflows.

Answer: A. Explanation: Headline CPI includes food and fuel while core measures exclude selected volatile components; low headline inflation does not mean every component or household basket became cheaper. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q26. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Headline and core inflation?

A. Foreign-exchange reserves are a point-in-time stock, while the current-account balance is a period flow; a large stock buffer does not by itself correct a persistent flow imbalance. B. Headline CPI includes food and fuel while core measures exclude selected volatile components; low headline inflation does not mean every component or household basket became cheaper. C. External debt is a liability stock measured at a stated date and must be assessed with maturity, currency, borrower and servicing capacity rather than confused with annual capital inflows. D. PLFS labour indicators depend on period, geography and status concept such as usual status or current weekly status; one rate without its denominator and method is incomplete.

Answer: B. Explanation: Headline CPI includes food and fuel while core measures exclude selected volatile components; low headline inflation does not mean every component or household basket became cheaper. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q27. Which statement uses Headline and core inflation without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. External debt is a liability stock measured at a stated date and must be assessed with maturity, currency, borrower and servicing capacity rather than confused with annual capital inflows. B. PLFS labour indicators depend on period, geography and status concept such as usual status or current weekly status; one rate without its denominator and method is incomplete. C. Headline CPI includes food and fuel while core measures exclude selected volatile components; low headline inflation does not mean every component or household basket became cheaper. D. A dashboard indicator must preserve whether it is a level, growth rate, ratio, share, index, stock, flow or per-capita measure and identify the denominator before comparison.

Answer: C. Explanation: Headline CPI includes food and fuel while core measures exclude selected volatile components; low headline inflation does not mean every component or household basket became cheaper.

The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q28. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Headline and core inflation?

A. PLFS labour indicators depend on period, geography and status concept such as usual status or current weekly status; one rate without its denominator and method is incomplete. B. A dashboard indicator must preserve whether it is a level, growth rate, ratio, share, index, stock, flow or per-capita measure and identify the denominator before comparison. C. An Economic Survey observation or projection, a Budget proposal and a subsequently reported official outturn are different evidence classes and must not be blended into one government commitment or achievement. D. Headline CPI includes food and fuel while core measures exclude selected volatile components; low headline inflation does not mean every component or household basket became cheaper.

Answer: D. Explanation: Headline CPI includes food and fuel while core measures exclude selected volatile components; low headline inflation does not mean every component or household basket became cheaper. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies High-frequency indicators?

A. High-frequency indicators provide timely signals before complete national accounts, but they are partial proxies whose seasonal, base and coverage effects must be checked. B. Foreign-exchange reserves are a point-in-time stock, while the current-account balance is a period flow; a large stock buffer does not by itself correct a persistent flow imbalance. C. External debt is a liability stock measured at a stated date and must be assessed with maturity, currency, borrower and servicing capacity rather than confused with annual capital inflows. D. PLFS labour indicators depend on period, geography and status concept such as usual status or current weekly status; one rate without its denominator and method is incomplete.

Answer: A. Explanation: High-frequency indicators provide timely signals before complete national accounts, but they are partial proxies whose seasonal, base and coverage effects must be checked. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q30. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of High-frequency indicators?

A. External debt is a liability stock measured at a stated date and must be assessed with maturity, currency, borrower and servicing capacity rather than confused with annual capital inflows. B. High-frequency indicators provide timely signals before complete national accounts, but they are partial proxies whose seasonal, base and coverage effects must be checked. C. PLFS labour indicators depend on period, geography and status concept such as usual status or current weekly status; one rate without its denominator and method is incomplete. D. A dashboard indicator must preserve whether it is a level, growth rate, ratio, share, index, stock, flow or per-capita measure and identify the denominator before comparison.

Answer: B. Explanation: High-frequency indicators provide timely signals before complete national accounts, but they are partial proxies whose seasonal, base and coverage effects must be checked. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q31. Which statement uses High-frequency indicators without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. PLFS labour indicators depend on period, geography and status concept such as usual status or current weekly status; one rate without its denominator and method is incomplete. B. A dashboard indicator must preserve whether it is a level, growth rate, ratio, share, index, stock, flow or per-capita measure and identify the denominator before comparison. C. High-frequency indicators provide timely signals before complete national accounts, but they are partial proxies whose seasonal, base and coverage effects must be checked. D. An Economic Survey observation or projection, a Budget proposal and a subsequently reported official outturn are different evidence classes and must not be blended into one government commitment or achievement.

Answer: C. Explanation: High-frequency indicators provide timely signals before complete national accounts, but they are partial proxies whose seasonal, base and coverage effects must be checked. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q32. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about High-frequency indicators?

A. A dashboard indicator must preserve whether it is a level, growth rate, ratio, share, index, stock, flow or per-capita measure and identify the denominator before comparison. B. An Economic Survey observation or projection, a Budget proposal and a subsequently reported official outturn are different evidence classes and must not be blended into one government commitment or achievement. C. A near-term forecast is conditional on assumptions and a data vintage, while potential growth is an assessment of sustainable capacity; neither is an achieved growth rate. D. High-frequency indicators provide timely signals before complete national accounts, but they are partial proxies whose seasonal, base and coverage effects must be checked.

Answer: D. Explanation: High-frequency indicators provide timely signals before complete national accounts, but they are partial proxies whose seasonal, base and coverage effects must be checked. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies Reserve stock and CAD flow?

A. Foreign-exchange reserves are a point-in-time stock, while the current-account balance is a period flow; a large stock buffer does not by itself correct a persistent flow imbalance. B. External debt is a liability stock measured at a stated date and must be assessed with maturity, currency, borrower and servicing capacity rather than confused with annual capital inflows. C. PLFS labour indicators depend on period, geography and status concept such as usual status or current weekly status; one rate without its denominator and method is incomplete. D. A dashboard indicator must preserve whether it is a level, growth rate, ratio, share, index, stock, flow or per-capita measure and identify the denominator before comparison.

Answer: A. Explanation: Foreign-exchange reserves are a point-in-time stock, while the current-account balance is a period flow; a large stock buffer does not by itself correct a persistent flow imbalance. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q34. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Reserve stock and CAD flow?

A. PLFS labour indicators depend on period, geography and status concept such as usual status or current weekly status; one rate without its denominator and method is incomplete. B. Foreign-exchange reserves are a point-in-time stock, while the current-account balance is a period flow; a large stock buffer does not by itself correct a persistent flow imbalance. C. A dashboard indicator must preserve whether it is a level, growth rate, ratio, share, index, stock, flow or per-capita measure and identify the denominator before comparison. D. An Economic Survey observation or projection, a Budget proposal and a subsequently reported official outturn are different evidence classes and must not be blended into one government commitment or achievement.

Answer: B. Explanation: Foreign-exchange reserves are a point-in-time stock, while the current-account balance is a period flow; a large stock buffer does not by itself correct a persistent flow imbalance. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q35. Which statement uses Reserve stock and CAD flow without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. A dashboard indicator must preserve whether it is a level, growth rate, ratio, share, index, stock, flow or per-capita measure and identify the denominator before comparison. B. An Economic Survey observation or projection, a Budget proposal and a subsequently reported official outturn are different evidence classes and must not be blended into one government commitment or achievement. C. Foreign-exchange reserves are a point-in-time stock, while the current-account balance is a period flow; a large stock buffer does not by itself correct a persistent flow imbalance. D. A near-term forecast is conditional on assumptions and a data vintage, while potential growth is an assessment of sustainable capacity; neither is an achieved growth rate.

Answer: C. Explanation: Foreign-exchange reserves are a point-in-time stock, while the current-account balance is a period flow; a large stock buffer does not by itself correct a persistent flow imbalance. The other

options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q36. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Reserve stock and CAD flow?

A. An Economic Survey observation or projection, a Budget proposal and a subsequently reported official outturn are different evidence classes and must not be blended into one government commitment or achievement. B. A near-term forecast is conditional on assumptions and a data vintage, while potential growth is an assessment of sustainable capacity; neither is an achieved growth rate. C. Macro stability combines manageable inflation, fiscal credibility, external resilience and financial soundness; one strong growth headline cannot establish stability across all boxes. D. Foreign-exchange reserves are a point-in-time stock, while the current-account balance is a period flow; a large stock buffer does not by itself correct a persistent flow imbalance.

Answer: D. Explanation: Foreign-exchange reserves are a point-in-time stock, while the current-account balance is a period flow; a large stock buffer does not by itself correct a persistent flow imbalance. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies External debt stock?

A. External debt is a liability stock measured at a stated date and must be assessed with maturity, currency, borrower and servicing capacity rather than confused with annual capital inflows. B. PLFS labour indicators depend on period, geography and status concept such as usual status or current weekly status; one rate without its denominator and method is incomplete. C. A dashboard indicator must preserve whether it is a level, growth rate, ratio, share, index, stock, flow or per-capita measure and identify the denominator before comparison. D. An Economic Survey observation or projection, a Budget proposal and a subsequently reported official outturn are different evidence classes and must not be blended into one government commitment or achievement.

Answer: A. Explanation: External debt is a liability stock measured at a stated date and must be assessed with maturity, currency, borrower and servicing capacity rather than confused with annual capital inflows. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q38. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of External debt stock?

A. A dashboard indicator must preserve whether it is a level, growth rate, ratio, share, index, stock, flow or per-capita measure and identify the denominator before comparison. B. External debt is a liability stock measured at a stated date and must be assessed with maturity, currency, borrower and servicing capacity rather than confused with annual capital inflows. C. An Economic Survey observation or projection, a Budget proposal and a subsequently reported official outturn are different evidence classes and must not be blended into one government commitment or achievement. D. A near-term forecast is conditional on assumptions and a data vintage, while potential growth is an assessment of sustainable capacity; neither is an achieved growth rate.

Answer: B. Explanation: External debt is a liability stock measured at a stated date and must be assessed with maturity, currency, borrower and servicing capacity rather than confused with annual capital inflows. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q39. Which statement uses External debt stock without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. An Economic Survey observation or projection, a Budget proposal and a subsequently reported official outturn are different evidence classes and must not be blended into one government commitment or achievement. B. A near-term forecast is conditional on assumptions and a data vintage, while potential growth is an assessment of sustainable capacity; neither is an achieved growth rate. C. External debt is a liability stock measured at a stated date and must be assessed with maturity, currency, borrower and servicing capacity rather than confused with annual capital inflows. D. Macro stability combines manageable inflation, fiscal credibility, external resilience and financial soundness; one strong growth headline cannot establish stability across all boxes.

Answer: C. Explanation: External debt is a liability stock measured at a stated date and must be assessed with maturity, currency, borrower and servicing capacity rather than confused with annual capital inflows. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

perimeters.

Q40. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about External debt stock?

A. A near-term forecast is conditional on assumptions and a data vintage, while potential growth is an assessment of sustainable capacity; neither is an achieved growth rate. B. Macro stability combines manageable inflation, fiscal credibility, external resilience and financial soundness; one strong growth headline cannot establish stability across all boxes. C. India's FY21 quarterly real-GDP path recorded a sharp contraction followed by sequential return to positive year-on-year growth, but a V-shaped aggregate path does not prove uniform sectoral or employment recovery. D. External debt is a liability stock measured at a stated date and must be assessed with maturity, currency, borrower and servicing capacity rather than confused with annual capital inflows.

Answer: D. Explanation: External debt is a liability stock measured at a stated date and must be assessed with maturity, currency, borrower and servicing capacity rather than confused with annual capital inflows. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies PLFS method boundary?

A. PLFS labour indicators depend on period, geography and status concept such as usual status or current weekly status; one rate without its denominator and method is incomplete. B. A dashboard indicator must preserve whether it is a level, growth rate, ratio, share, index, stock, flow or per-capita measure and identify the denominator before comparison. C. An Economic Survey observation or projection, a Budget proposal and a subsequently reported official outturn are different evidence classes and must not be blended into one government commitment or achievement. D. A near-term forecast is conditional on assumptions and a data vintage, while potential growth is an assessment of sustainable capacity; neither is an achieved growth rate.

Answer: A. Explanation: PLFS labour indicators depend on period, geography and status concept such as usual status or current weekly status; one rate without its denominator and method is incomplete. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q42. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of PLFS method boundary?

A. An Economic Survey observation or projection, a Budget proposal and a subsequently reported official outturn are different evidence classes and must not be blended into one government commitment or achievement. B. PLFS labour indicators depend on period, geography and status concept such as usual status or current weekly status; one rate without its denominator and method is incomplete. C. A near-term forecast is conditional on assumptions and a data vintage, while potential growth is an assessment of sustainable capacity; neither is an achieved growth rate. D. Macro stability combines manageable inflation, fiscal credibility, external resilience and financial soundness; one strong growth headline cannot establish stability across all boxes.

Answer: B. Explanation: PLFS labour indicators depend on period, geography and status concept such as usual status or current weekly status; one rate without its denominator and method is incomplete. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q43. Which statement uses PLFS method boundary without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. A near-term forecast is conditional on assumptions and a data vintage, while potential growth is an assessment of sustainable capacity; neither is an achieved growth rate. B. Macro stability combines manageable inflation, fiscal credibility, external resilience and financial soundness; one strong growth headline cannot establish stability across all boxes. C. PLFS labour indicators depend on period, geography and status concept such as usual status or current weekly status; one rate without its denominator and method is incomplete. D. India's FY21 quarterly real-GDP path recorded a sharp contraction followed by sequential return to positive year-on-year growth, but a V-shaped aggregate path does not prove uniform sectoral or employment recovery.

Answer: C. Explanation: PLFS labour indicators depend on period, geography and status concept such as usual status or current weekly status; one rate without its denominator and method is incomplete. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q44. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about PLFS method boundary?

A. Macro stability combines manageable inflation, fiscal credibility, external resilience and financial soundness; one strong growth headline cannot establish stability across all boxes. B. India's FY21 quarterly real-GDP path recorded a sharp contraction followed by sequential return to positive year-on-year growth, but a V-shaped aggregate path does not prove uniform sectoral or employment recovery. C. The owner distinguishes the NSO May 2021 provisional full-year FY21 contraction estimate of 7.3 percent from the January 2022 revised estimate of 6.6 percent, illustrating why estimate vintage must be retained. D. PLFS labour indicators depend on period, geography and status concept such as usual status or current weekly status; one rate without its denominator and method is incomplete.

Answer: D. Explanation: PLFS labour indicators depend on period, geography and status concept such as usual status or current weekly status; one rate without its denominator and method is incomplete. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies Dashboard denominator?

A. A dashboard indicator must preserve whether it is a level, growth rate, ratio, share, index, stock, flow or per-capita measure and identify the denominator before comparison. B. An Economic Survey observation or projection, a Budget proposal and a subsequently reported official outturn are different evidence classes and must not be blended into one government commitment or achievement. C. A near-term forecast is conditional on assumptions and a data vintage, while potential growth is an assessment of sustainable capacity; neither is an achieved growth rate. D. Macro stability combines manageable inflation, fiscal credibility, external resilience and financial soundness; one strong growth headline cannot establish stability across all boxes.

Answer: A. Explanation: A dashboard indicator must preserve whether it is a level, growth rate, ratio, share, index, stock, flow or per-capita measure and identify the denominator before comparison. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q46. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Dashboard denominator?

A. A near-term forecast is conditional on assumptions and a data vintage, while potential growth is an assessment of sustainable capacity; neither is an achieved growth rate. B. A dashboard indicator must preserve whether it is a level, growth rate, ratio, share, index, stock, flow or per-capita measure and identify the denominator before comparison. C. Macro stability combines manageable inflation, fiscal credibility, external resilience and financial soundness; one strong growth headline cannot establish stability across all boxes. D. India's FY21 quarterly real-GDP path recorded a sharp contraction followed by sequential return to positive year-on-year growth, but a V-shaped aggregate path does not prove uniform sectoral or employment recovery.

Answer: B. Explanation: A dashboard indicator must preserve whether it is a level, growth rate, ratio, share, index, stock, flow or per-capita measure and identify the denominator before comparison. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q47. Which statement uses Dashboard denominator without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Macro stability combines manageable inflation, fiscal credibility, external resilience and financial soundness; one strong growth headline cannot establish stability across all boxes. B. India's FY21 quarterly real-GDP path recorded a sharp contraction followed by sequential return to positive year-on-year growth, but a V-shaped aggregate path does not prove uniform sectoral or employment recovery. C. A dashboard indicator must preserve whether it is a level, growth rate, ratio, share, index, stock, flow or per-capita measure and identify the denominator before comparison. D. The owner distinguishes the NSO May 2021 provisional full-year FY21 contraction estimate of 7.3 percent from the January 2022 revised estimate of 6.6 percent, illustrating why estimate vintage must be retained.

Answer: C. Explanation: A dashboard indicator must preserve whether it is a level, growth rate, ratio, share, index, stock, flow or per-capita measure and identify the denominator before comparison. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q48. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Dashboard denominator?

A. India's FY21 quarterly real-GDP path recorded a sharp contraction followed by sequential return to positive year-on-year growth, but a V-shaped aggregate path does not prove uniform sectoral or employment recovery. B. The owner distinguishes the NSO May 2021 provisional full-year FY21 contraction estimate of 7.3 percent from the January 2022 revised estimate of 6.6 percent, illustrating why estimate vintage must be retained. C. The World Economic Forum published the Global Competitiveness Report or Index and discontinued that specific annual series after 2019-20; IMD's separate ranking must not be substituted for it. D. A dashboard indicator must preserve whether it is a level, growth rate, ratio, share, index, stock, flow or per-capita measure and identify the denominator before comparison.

Answer: D. Explanation: A dashboard indicator must preserve whether it is a level, growth rate, ratio, share, index, stock, flow or per-capita measure and identify the denominator before comparison. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies Survey, Budget and outturn?

A. An Economic Survey observation or projection, a Budget proposal and a subsequently reported official outturn are different evidence classes and must not be blended into one government commitment or achievement. B. A near-term forecast is conditional on assumptions and a data vintage, while potential growth is an assessment of sustainable capacity; neither is an achieved growth rate. C. Macro stability combines manageable inflation, fiscal credibility, external resilience and financial soundness; one strong growth headline cannot establish stability across all boxes. D. India's FY21 quarterly real-GDP path recorded a sharp contraction followed by sequential return to positive year-on-year growth, but a V-shaped aggregate path does not prove uniform sectoral or employment recovery.

Answer: A. Explanation: An Economic Survey observation or projection, a Budget proposal and a subsequently reported official outturn are different evidence classes and must not be blended into one government commitment or achievement. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q50. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Survey, Budget and outturn?

A. Macro stability combines manageable inflation, fiscal credibility, external resilience and financial soundness; one strong growth headline cannot establish stability across all boxes. B. An Economic Survey observation or projection, a Budget proposal and a subsequently reported official outturn are different evidence classes and must not be blended into one government commitment or achievement. C. India's FY21 quarterly real-GDP path recorded a sharp contraction followed by sequential return to positive year-on-year growth, but a V-shaped aggregate path does not prove uniform sectoral or employment recovery. D. The owner distinguishes the NSO May 2021 provisional full-year FY21 contraction estimate of 7.3 percent from the January 2022 revised estimate of 6.6 percent, illustrating why estimate vintage must be retained.

Answer: B. Explanation: An Economic Survey observation or projection, a Budget proposal and a subsequently reported official outturn are different evidence classes and must not be blended into one government commitment or achievement. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q51. Which statement uses Survey, Budget and outturn without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. India's FY21 quarterly real-GDP path recorded a sharp contraction followed by sequential return to positive year-on-year growth, but a V-shaped aggregate path does not prove uniform sectoral or employment recovery. B. The owner distinguishes the NSO May 2021 provisional full-year FY21 contraction estimate of 7.3 percent from the January 2022 revised estimate of 6.6 percent, illustrating why estimate vintage must be retained. C. An Economic Survey observation or projection, a Budget proposal and a subsequently reported official outturn are different evidence classes and must not be blended into one government commitment or achievement. D. The World Economic Forum published the Global Competitiveness Report or Index and discontinued that specific annual series after 2019-20; IMD's separate ranking must not be substituted for it.

Answer: C. Explanation: An Economic Survey observation or projection, a Budget proposal and a subsequently reported official outturn are different evidence classes and must not be blended into one government commitment or achievement. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q52. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Survey, Budget and outturn?

A. The owner distinguishes the NSO May 2021 provisional full-year FY21 contraction estimate of 7.3 percent from the January 2022 revised estimate of 6.6 percent, illustrating why estimate vintage must be retained. B. The World Economic Forum published the Global Competitiveness Report or Index and discontinued that specific annual series after 2019-20; IMD's separate ranking must not be substituted for it. C. Cross-box synthesis is valid only when growth, prices, fiscal, external and labour indicators use comparable and clearly labelled periods; mixing unmatched vintages can create false divergence. D. An Economic Survey observation or projection, a Budget proposal and a subsequently reported official outturn are different evidence classes and must not be blended into one government commitment or achievement.

Answer: D. Explanation: An Economic Survey observation or projection, a Budget proposal and a subsequently reported official outturn are different evidence classes and must not be blended into one government commitment or achievement. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies Forecast and potential growth?

A. A near-term forecast is conditional on assumptions and a data vintage, while potential growth is an assessment of sustainable capacity; neither is an achieved growth rate. B. Macro stability combines manageable inflation, fiscal credibility, external resilience and financial soundness; one strong growth headline cannot establish stability across all boxes. C. India's FY21 quarterly real-GDP path recorded a sharp contraction followed by sequential return to positive year-on-year growth, but a V-shaped aggregate path does not prove uniform sectoral or employment recovery. D. The owner distinguishes the NSO May 2021 provisional full-year FY21 contraction estimate of 7.3 percent from the January 2022 revised estimate of 6.6 percent, illustrating why estimate vintage must be retained.

Answer: A. Explanation: A near-term forecast is conditional on assumptions and a data vintage, while potential growth is an assessment of sustainable capacity; neither is an achieved growth rate. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q54. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Forecast and potential growth?

A. India's FY21 quarterly real-GDP path recorded a sharp contraction followed by sequential return to positive year-on-year growth, but a V-shaped aggregate path does not prove uniform sectoral or employment recovery. B. A near-term forecast is conditional on assumptions and a data vintage, while potential growth is an assessment of sustainable capacity; neither is an achieved growth rate. C. The owner distinguishes the NSO May 2021 provisional full-year FY21 contraction estimate of 7.3 percent from the January 2022 revised estimate of 6.6 percent, illustrating why estimate vintage must be retained. D. The World Economic Forum published the Global Competitiveness Report or Index and discontinued that specific annual series after 2019-20; IMD's separate ranking must not be substituted for it.

Answer: B. Explanation: A near-term forecast is conditional on assumptions and a data vintage, while potential growth is an assessment of sustainable capacity; neither is an achieved growth rate. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q55. Which statement uses Forecast and potential growth without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. The owner distinguishes the NSO May 2021 provisional full-year FY21 contraction estimate of 7.3 percent from the January 2022 revised estimate of 6.6 percent, illustrating why estimate vintage must be retained. B. The World Economic Forum published the Global Competitiveness Report or Index and discontinued that specific annual series after 2019-20; IMD's separate ranking must not be substituted for it. C. A near-term forecast is conditional on assumptions and a data vintage, while potential growth is an assessment of sustainable capacity; neither is an achieved growth rate. D. Cross-box synthesis is valid only when growth, prices, fiscal, external and labour indicators use comparable and clearly labelled periods; mixing unmatched vintages can create false divergence.

Answer: C. Explanation: A near-term forecast is conditional on assumptions and a data vintage, while potential growth is an assessment of sustainable capacity; neither is an achieved growth rate. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q56. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Forecast and potential growth?

A. The World Economic Forum published the Global Competitiveness Report or Index and discontinued that specific annual series after 2019-20; IMD's separate ranking must not be substituted for it. B. Cross-box synthesis is valid only when growth, prices, fiscal, external and labour indicators use comparable and clearly labelled periods; mixing unmatched vintages can create false divergence. C. Strategic resilience is the capacity to absorb shocks, while strategic indispensability is the capacity to become a reliable valuable node in global systems; buffers alone do not create productive capability. D. A near-term forecast is conditional on assumptions and a data vintage, while potential growth is an assessment of sustainable capacity; neither is an achieved growth rate.

Answer: D. Explanation: A near-term forecast is conditional on assumptions and a data vintage, while potential growth is an assessment of sustainable capacity; neither is an achieved growth rate. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Macro-stability frame?

A. Macro stability combines manageable inflation, fiscal credibility, external resilience and financial soundness; one strong growth headline cannot establish stability across all boxes. B. India's FY21 quarterly real-GDP path recorded a sharp contraction followed by sequential return to positive year-on-year growth, but a V-shaped aggregate path does not prove uniform sectoral or employment recovery. C. The owner distinguishes the NSO May 2021 provisional full-year FY21 contraction estimate of 7.3 percent from the January 2022 revised estimate of 6.6 percent, illustrating why estimate vintage must be retained. D. The World Economic Forum published the Global Competitiveness Report or Index and discontinued that specific annual series after 2019-20; IMD's separate ranking must not be substituted for it.

Answer: A. Explanation: Macro stability combines manageable inflation, fiscal credibility, external resilience and financial soundness; one strong growth headline cannot establish stability across all boxes. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q58. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Macro-stability frame?

A. The owner distinguishes the NSO May 2021 provisional full-year FY21 contraction estimate of 7.3 percent from the January 2022 revised estimate of 6.6 percent, illustrating why estimate vintage must be retained. B. Macro stability combines manageable inflation, fiscal credibility, external resilience and financial soundness; one strong growth headline cannot establish stability across all boxes. C. The World Economic Forum published the Global Competitiveness Report or Index and discontinued that specific annual series after 2019-20; IMD's separate ranking must not be substituted for it. D. Cross-box synthesis is valid only when growth, prices, fiscal, external and labour indicators use comparable and clearly labelled periods; mixing unmatched vintages can create false divergence.

Answer: B. Explanation: Macro stability combines manageable inflation, fiscal credibility, external resilience and financial soundness; one strong growth headline cannot establish stability across all boxes. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q59. Which statement uses Macro-stability frame without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. The World Economic Forum published the Global Competitiveness Report or Index and discontinued that specific annual series after 2019-20; IMD's separate ranking must not be substituted for it. B. Cross-box synthesis is valid only when growth, prices, fiscal, external and labour indicators use comparable and clearly labelled periods; mixing unmatched vintages can create false divergence. C. Macro stability combines manageable inflation, fiscal credibility, external resilience and financial soundness; one strong growth headline cannot establish stability across all boxes. D. Strategic resilience is the capacity to absorb shocks, while strategic indispensability is the capacity to become a reliable valuable node in global systems; buffers alone do not create productive capability.

Answer: C. Explanation: Macro stability combines manageable inflation, fiscal credibility, external resilience and financial soundness; one strong growth headline cannot establish stability across all boxes. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q60. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Macro-stability frame?

A. Cross-box synthesis is valid only when growth, prices, fiscal, external and labour indicators use comparable and clearly labelled periods; mixing unmatched vintages can create false divergence. B. Strategic resilience is the capacity to absorb shocks, while strategic indispensability is the capacity to become a reliable valuable node in global systems; buffers alone do not create productive capability. C. A First Advance Estimate is released before complete annual data and is revised as fuller information arrives; it is neither a final audited outcome nor a timeless current fact. D. Macro stability combines manageable inflation, fiscal credibility, external resilience and financial soundness; one strong growth headline cannot establish stability across all boxes.

Answer: D. Explanation: Macro stability combines manageable inflation, fiscal credibility, external resilience and financial soundness; one strong growth headline cannot establish stability across all boxes. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies V-shaped recovery boundary?

A. India's FY21 quarterly real-GDP path recorded a sharp contraction followed by sequential return to positive year-on-year growth, but a V-shaped aggregate path does not prove uniform sectoral or employment recovery. B. The owner distinguishes the NSO May 2021 provisional full-year FY21 contraction estimate of 7.3 percent from the January 2022 revised estimate of 6.6 percent, illustrating why estimate vintage must be retained. C. The World Economic Forum published the Global Competitiveness Report or Index and discontinued that specific annual series after 2019-20; IMD's separate ranking must not be substituted for it. D. Cross-box synthesis is valid only when growth, prices, fiscal, external and labour indicators use comparable and clearly labelled periods; mixing unmatched vintages can create false divergence.

Answer: A. Explanation: India's FY21 quarterly real-GDP path recorded a sharp contraction followed by sequential return to positive year-on-year growth, but a V-shaped aggregate path does not prove uniform sectoral or employment recovery. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q62. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of V-shaped recovery boundary?

A. The World Economic Forum published the Global Competitiveness Report or Index and discontinued that specific annual series after 2019-20; IMD's separate ranking must not be substituted for it. B. India's FY21 quarterly real-GDP path recorded a sharp contraction followed by sequential return to positive year-on-year growth, but a V-shaped aggregate path does not prove uniform sectoral or employment recovery. C. Cross-box synthesis is valid only when growth, prices, fiscal, external and labour indicators use comparable and clearly labelled periods; mixing unmatched vintages can create false divergence. D. Strategic resilience is the capacity to absorb shocks, while strategic indispensability is the capacity to become a reliable valuable node in global systems; buffers alone do not create productive capability.

Answer: B. Explanation: India's FY21 quarterly real-GDP path recorded a sharp contraction followed by sequential return to positive year-on-year growth, but a V-shaped aggregate path does not prove uniform

sectoral or employment recovery. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q63. Which statement uses V-shaped recovery boundary without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Cross-box synthesis is valid only when growth, prices, fiscal, external and labour indicators use comparable and clearly labelled periods; mixing unmatched vintages can create false divergence. B. Strategic resilience is the capacity to absorb shocks, while strategic indispensability is the capacity to become a reliable valuable node in global systems; buffers alone do not create productive capability. C. India's FY21 quarterly real-GDP path recorded a sharp contraction followed by sequential return to positive year-on-year growth, but a V-shaped aggregate path does not prove uniform sectoral or employment recovery. D. A First Advance Estimate is released before complete annual data and is revised as fuller information arrives; it is neither a final audited outcome nor a timeless current fact.

Answer: C. Explanation: India's FY21 quarterly real-GDP path recorded a sharp contraction followed by sequential return to positive year-on-year growth, but a V-shaped aggregate path does not prove uniform sectoral or employment recovery. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q64. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about V-shaped recovery boundary?

A. Strategic resilience is the capacity to absorb shocks, while strategic indispensability is the capacity to become a reliable valuable node in global systems; buffers alone do not create productive capability. B. A First Advance Estimate is released before complete annual data and is revised as fuller information arrives; it is neither a final audited outcome nor a timeless current fact. C. GDP at market prices and GVA at basic prices answer related but distinct questions, so tax and subsidy effects can make their growth rates differ without contradiction. D. India's FY21 quarterly real-GDP path recorded a sharp contraction followed by sequential return to positive year-on-year growth, but a V-shaped aggregate path does not prove uniform sectoral or employment recovery.

Answer: D. Explanation: India's FY21 quarterly real-GDP path recorded a sharp contraction followed by sequential return to positive year-on-year growth, but a V-shaped aggregate path does not prove uniform sectoral or employment recovery. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies FY21 revision example?

A. The owner distinguishes the NSO May 2021 provisional full-year FY21 contraction estimate of 7.3 percent from the January 2022 revised estimate of 6.6 percent, illustrating why estimate vintage must be retained. B. The World Economic Forum published the Global Competitiveness Report or Index and discontinued that specific annual series after 2019-20; IMD's separate ranking must not be substituted for it. C. Cross-box synthesis is valid only when growth, prices, fiscal, external and labour indicators use comparable and clearly labelled periods; mixing unmatched vintages can create false divergence. D. Strategic resilience is the capacity to absorb shocks, while strategic indispensability is the capacity to become a reliable valuable node in global systems; buffers alone do not create productive capability.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owner distinguishes the NSO May 2021 provisional full-year FY21 contraction estimate of 7.3 percent from the January 2022 revised estimate of 6.6 percent, illustrating why estimate vintage must be retained. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q66. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of FY21 revision example?

A. Cross-box synthesis is valid only when growth, prices, fiscal, external and labour indicators use comparable and clearly labelled periods; mixing unmatched vintages can create false divergence. B. The owner distinguishes the NSO May 2021 provisional full-year FY21 contraction estimate of 7.3 percent from the January 2022 revised estimate of 6.6 percent, illustrating why estimate vintage must be retained. C. Strategic resilience is the capacity to absorb shocks, while strategic indispensability is the capacity to become a reliable valuable node in global systems; buffers alone do not create productive capability. D. A First Advance Estimate is released before complete annual data and is revised as fuller information arrives; it is neither a final audited outcome nor a timeless current fact.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owner distinguishes the NSO May 2021 provisional full-year FY21 contraction estimate of 7.3 percent from the January 2022 revised estimate of 6.6 percent, illustrating why estimate vintage must be retained. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q67. Which statement uses FY21 revision example without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Strategic resilience is the capacity to absorb shocks, while strategic indispensability is the capacity to become a reliable valuable node in global systems; buffers alone do not create productive capability. B. A First Advance Estimate is released before complete annual data and is revised as fuller information arrives; it is neither a final audited outcome nor a timeless current fact. C. The owner distinguishes the NSO May 2021 provisional full-year FY21 contraction estimate of 7.3 percent from the January 2022 revised estimate of 6.6 percent, illustrating why estimate vintage must be retained. D. GDP at market prices and GVA at basic prices answer related but distinct questions, so tax and subsidy effects can make their growth rates differ without contradiction.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owner distinguishes the NSO May 2021 provisional full-year FY21 contraction estimate of 7.3 percent from the January 2022 revised estimate of 6.6 percent, illustrating why estimate vintage must be retained. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q68. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about FY21 revision example?

A. A First Advance Estimate is released before complete annual data and is revised as fuller information arrives; it is neither a final audited outcome nor a timeless current fact. B. GDP at market prices and GVA at basic prices answer related but distinct questions, so tax and subsidy effects can make their growth rates differ without contradiction. C. Real aggregates remove price change using a stated base and method, while nominal aggregates value output at current prices; a real growth rate cannot be compared directly with a nominal level. D. The owner distinguishes the NSO May 2021 provisional full-year FY21 contraction estimate of 7.3 percent from the January 2022 revised estimate of 6.6 percent, illustrating why estimate vintage must be retained.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owner distinguishes the NSO May 2021 provisional full-year FY21 contraction estimate of 7.3 percent from the January 2022 revised estimate of 6.6 percent, illustrating why estimate vintage must be retained. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Global Competitiveness Report?

A. The World Economic Forum published the Global Competitiveness Report or Index and discontinued that specific annual series after 2019-20; IMD's separate ranking must not be substituted for it. B. Cross-box synthesis is valid only when growth, prices, fiscal, external and labour indicators use comparable and clearly labelled periods; mixing unmatched vintages can create false divergence. C. Strategic resilience is the capacity to absorb shocks, while strategic indispensability is the capacity to become a reliable valuable node in global systems; buffers alone do not create productive capability. D. A First Advance Estimate is released before complete annual data and is revised as fuller information arrives; it is neither a final audited outcome nor a timeless current fact.

Answer: A. Explanation: The World Economic Forum published the Global Competitiveness Report or Index and discontinued that specific annual series after 2019-20; IMD's separate ranking must not be substituted for it. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal

perimeters.

Q70. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Global Competitiveness Report?

A. Strategic resilience is the capacity to absorb shocks, while strategic indispensability is the capacity to become a reliable valuable node in global systems; buffers alone do not create productive capability. B. The World Economic Forum published the Global Competitiveness Report or Index and discontinued that specific annual series after 2019-20; IMD's separate ranking must not be substituted for it. C. A First Advance Estimate is released before complete annual data and is revised as fuller information arrives; it is neither a final audited outcome nor a timeless current fact. D. GDP at market prices and GVA at basic prices answer related but distinct questions, so tax and subsidy effects can make their growth rates differ without contradiction.

Answer: B. Explanation: The World Economic Forum published the Global Competitiveness Report or Index and discontinued that specific annual series after 2019-20; IMD's separate ranking must not be substituted for it. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q71. Which statement uses Global Competitiveness Report without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. A First Advance Estimate is released before complete annual data and is revised as fuller information arrives; it is neither a final audited outcome nor a timeless current fact. B. GDP at market prices and GVA at basic prices answer related but distinct questions, so tax and subsidy effects can make their growth rates differ without contradiction. C. The World Economic Forum published the Global Competitiveness Report or Index and discontinued that specific annual series after 2019-20; IMD's separate ranking must not be substituted for it. D. Real aggregates remove price change using a stated base and method, while nominal aggregates value output at current prices; a real growth rate cannot be compared directly with a nominal level.

Answer: C. Explanation: The World Economic Forum published the Global Competitiveness Report or Index and discontinued that specific annual series after 2019-20; IMD's separate ranking must not be substituted for it. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q72. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Global Competitiveness Report?

A. GDP at market prices and GVA at basic prices answer related but distinct questions, so tax and subsidy effects can make their growth rates differ without contradiction. B. Real aggregates remove price change using a stated base and method, while nominal aggregates value output at current prices; a real growth rate cannot be compared directly with a nominal level. C. PFCE, government consumption, gross capital formation and net exports describe expenditure composition; a component's share of GDP and its growth rate are different measures. D. The World Economic Forum published the Global Competitiveness Report or Index and discontinued that specific annual series after 2019-20; IMD's separate ranking must not be substituted for it.

Answer: D. Explanation: The World Economic Forum published the Global Competitiveness Report or Index and discontinued that specific annual series after 2019-20; IMD's separate ranking must not be substituted for it. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Comparable-period synthesis?

A. Cross-box synthesis is valid only when growth, prices, fiscal, external and labour indicators use comparable and clearly labelled periods; mixing unmatched vintages can create false divergence. B. Strategic resilience is the capacity to absorb shocks, while strategic indispensability is the capacity to become a reliable valuable node in global systems; buffers alone do not create productive capability. C. A First Advance Estimate is released before complete annual data and is revised as fuller information arrives; it is neither a final audited outcome nor a timeless current fact. D. GDP at market prices and GVA at basic prices answer related but distinct questions, so tax and subsidy effects can make their growth rates differ without contradiction.

Answer: A. Explanation: Cross-box synthesis is valid only when growth, prices, fiscal, external and labour indicators use comparable and clearly labelled periods; mixing unmatched vintages can create false divergence. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q74. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Comparable-period synthesis?

A. A First Advance Estimate is released before complete annual data and is revised as fuller information arrives; it is neither a final audited outcome nor a timeless current fact. B. Cross-box synthesis is valid only when growth, prices, fiscal, external and labour indicators use comparable and clearly labelled periods; mixing unmatched vintages can create false divergence. C. GDP at market prices and GVA at basic prices answer related but distinct questions, so tax and subsidy effects can make their growth rates differ without contradiction. D. Real aggregates remove price change using a stated base and method, while nominal aggregates value output at current prices; a real growth rate cannot be compared directly with a nominal level.

Answer: B. Explanation: Cross-box synthesis is valid only when growth, prices, fiscal, external and labour indicators use comparable and clearly labelled periods; mixing unmatched vintages can create false divergence. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q75. Which statement uses Comparable-period synthesis without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. GDP at market prices and GVA at basic prices answer related but distinct questions, so tax and subsidy effects can make their growth rates differ without contradiction. B. Real aggregates remove price change using a stated base and method, while nominal aggregates value output at current prices; a real growth rate cannot be compared directly with a nominal level. C. Cross-box synthesis is valid only when growth, prices, fiscal, external and labour indicators use comparable and clearly labelled periods; mixing unmatched vintages can create false divergence. D. PFCE, government consumption, gross capital formation and net exports describe expenditure composition; a component's share of GDP and its growth rate are different measures.

Answer: C. Explanation: Cross-box synthesis is valid only when growth, prices, fiscal, external and labour indicators use comparable and clearly labelled periods; mixing unmatched vintages can create false divergence. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q76. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Comparable-period synthesis?

A. Real aggregates remove price change using a stated base and method, while nominal aggregates value output at current prices; a real growth rate cannot be compared directly with a nominal level. B. PFCE, government consumption, gross capital formation and net exports describe expenditure composition; a component's share of GDP and its growth rate are different measures. C. National accounts move through advance, provisional and revised estimates as data improve; every quoted figure must retain the release date and estimate vintage used by the source. D. Cross-box synthesis is valid only when growth, prices, fiscal, external and labour indicators use comparable and clearly labelled periods; mixing unmatched vintages can create false divergence.

Answer: D. Explanation: Cross-box synthesis is valid only when growth, prices, fiscal, external and labour indicators are comparable and clearly labelled periods; mixing unmatched vintages can create false divergence. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Strategic resilience and indispensability?

A. Strategic resilience is the capacity to absorb shocks, while strategic indispensability is the capacity to become a reliable valuable node in global systems; buffers alone do not create productive capability. B. A First Advance Estimate is released before complete annual data and is revised as fuller information arrives; it is neither a final audited outcome nor a timeless current fact. C. GDP at market prices and GVA at basic prices answer related but distinct questions, so tax and subsidy effects can make their growth rates differ without contradiction. D. Real aggregates remove price change using a stated base and method, while nominal aggregates value output at current prices; a real growth rate cannot be compared directly with a nominal level.

Answer: A. Explanation: Strategic resilience is the capacity to absorb shocks, while strategic indispensability is the capacity to become a reliable valuable node in global systems; buffers alone do not create productive capability. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q78. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Strategic resilience and indispensability?

A. GDP at market prices and GVA at basic prices answer related but distinct questions, so tax and subsidy effects can make their growth rates differ without contradiction. B. Strategic resilience is the capacity to absorb shocks, while strategic indispensability is the capacity to become a reliable valuable node in global systems; buffers alone do not create productive capability. C. Real aggregates remove price change using a stated base and method, while nominal aggregates value output at current prices; a real growth rate cannot be compared directly with a nominal level. D. PFCE, government consumption, gross capital formation and net exports describe expenditure composition; a component's share of GDP and its growth rate are different measures.

Answer: B. Explanation: Strategic resilience is the capacity to absorb shocks, while strategic indispensability is the capacity to become a reliable valuable node in global systems; buffers alone do not create productive capability. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q79. Which statement uses Strategic resilience and indispensability without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Real aggregates remove price change using a stated base and method, while nominal aggregates value output at current prices; a real growth rate cannot be compared directly with a nominal level. B. PFCE, government consumption, gross capital formation and net exports describe expenditure composition; a component's share of GDP and its growth rate are different measures. C. Strategic resilience is the capacity to absorb shocks, while strategic indispensability is the capacity to become a reliable valuable node in global systems; buffers alone do not create productive capability. D. National accounts move through advance, provisional and revised estimates as data improve; every quoted figure must retain the release date and estimate vintage used by the source.

Answer: C. Explanation: Strategic resilience is the capacity to absorb shocks, while strategic indispensability is the capacity to become a reliable valuable node in global systems; buffers alone do not create productive capability. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q80. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Strategic resilience and indispensability?

A. PFCE, government consumption, gross capital formation and net exports describe expenditure composition; a component's share of GDP and its growth rate are different measures. B. National accounts move through advance, provisional and revised estimates as data improve; every quoted figure must retain the release date and estimate vintage used by the source. C. Budget Estimate is a forward plan, Revised Estimate is an in-year reassessment and CGA provisional or final accounts report realised fiscal flows; proposal, revision and outturn are not interchangeable. D. Strategic resilience is the capacity to absorb shocks, while strategic indispensability is the capacity to become a reliable valuable node in global systems; buffers alone do not create productive capability.

Answer: D. Explanation: Strategic resilience is the capacity to absorb shocks, while strategic indispensability is the capacity to become a reliable valuable node in global systems; buffers alone do not create productive capability. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Semantic-completeness coverage drills - Topic 26

Drill	Prompt	Minimum answer route	Fatal trap
A	Why is AD 750 not a universal break?	multiple criteria -> regional phases -> continuity/change	one date for all India
B	Does every grant prove feudalism?	recipient/right/formula -> ground effect -> alternative integration	grant equals feudalism
C	What changed under samanta relations?	title history -> tribute/service/local power -> scale	fixed legal class
D	Did trade and towns collapse?	coin/town/import evidence -> regional contraction -> new nodes/revival	universal decline
E	How did temples and monasteries matter?	ritual + land + labour + redistribution + archive + local variation	merely religious
F	Was Brahmanization passive assimilation?	grant/cult/status -> localization -> tribal/local agency -> unequal reciprocity	one-way replacement
G	Evaluate social change.	varna text -> jati/occupation/exclusion -> gender/property/labour -> source limits	prescription equals practice
H	Compare regions.	north + east + Deccan + south/frontier -> different sequences	one pan-Indian model

PYQ status drill: all ten retained PYQs are adjacent-owned; none is routed directly to Topic 26.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT

Audited ledgers route the 2021 V-shaped-recovery Mains demand and the 2019 objective demand on the Global Competitiveness Report publisher. The package retains the provisional-versus-revised FY21 figures and does not infer an unavailable objective key.

OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS

9. PYQ application

- ANALYSIS: Apply Survey figures only after defining the tested static concept and attaching the exact period.
- ANALYSIS: 2024-26 PYQs reward institution-function matching, qualified statements and mechanism-based application.
- ANALYSIS: 2021 GS-III: "Do you agree that India's economic recovery after COVID-19 was V-shaped?"

- answer with the FY21 quarterly GDP path and base-effect logic above, then test the claim against sectoral unevenness and the employment/informality (K-shaped) evidence before reaching a qualified verdict.
- **ANALYSIS:** 2019 Prelims: Global Competitiveness Report's publishing institution - answer with the World Economic Forum attribution and the discontinuation-after-2019-2020 status caution above, distinguishing it from the IMD World Competitiveness Center's separate ranking.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS3-GS4-2018-2023.md, _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2018-2023.md.
Answer-key rule: The official 2018-2023 Prelims/CSAT keys are not held locally; no option or answer has been inferred.

- **Years represented:** 2019, 2021
- **Paper(s):** GS-III, Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 2

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2019	Prelims GS-I	3	Global Competitiveness Report publisher institution	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2021	GS-III	11	V-shaped economic recovery of India after COVID-19	Do you agree · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Global Competitiveness Report publisher institution
- V-shaped economic recovery of India after COVID-19

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

10. PYQ-based analytical application

- **ANALYSIS:** Apply Survey figures only after defining the tested static concept and attaching the exact period.
- **ANALYSIS:** 2024-26 PYQs reward institution-function matching, qualified statements and mechanism-based application.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS3-GS4-2018-2023.md.

- **Years represented:** 2021
- **Paper(s):** GS-III
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2021	GS-III	11	V-shaped economic recovery of India after COVID-19	Do you agree · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- V-shaped economic recovery of India after COVID-19

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2021 GS-III

Demand: Whether India's economic recovery after COVID-19 was V-shaped.

Status: Official-paper demand routed in the audited 2018-2023 GS-III ledger.

Model solution: High-frequency indicators: High-frequency indicators provide timely signals before complete national accounts, but they are partial proxies whose seasonal, base and coverage effects must be checked.

V-shaped recovery boundary: India's FY21 quarterly real-GDP path recorded a sharp contraction followed by sequential return to positive year-on-year growth, but a V-shaped aggregate path does not prove uniform sectoral or employment recovery. **FY21 revision example:** The owner distinguishes the NSO May 2021 provisional full-year FY21 contraction estimate of 7.3 percent from the January 2022 revised estimate of 6.6 percent, illustrating why estimate vintage must be retained. **Comparable-period synthesis:** Cross-box synthesis is valid only when growth, prices, fiscal, external and labour indicators use comparable and clearly labelled periods; mixing unmatched vintages can create false divergence. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2021 GS-III", every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: High-frequency indicators: High-frequency indicators provide timely signals before complete national accounts, but they are partial proxies whose seasonal, base and coverage effects must be checked.

V-shaped recovery boundary: India's FY21 quarterly real-GDP path recorded a sharp contraction followed by sequential return to positive year-on-year growth, but a V-shaped aggregate path does not prove uniform sectoral or employment recovery. **FY21 revision example:** The owner distinguishes the NSO May 2021 provisional full-year FY21 contraction estimate of 7.3 percent from the January 2022 revised estimate of 6.6 percent, illustrating why estimate vintage must be retained. **Comparable-period synthesis:** Cross-box synthesis is valid only when growth, prices, fiscal, external and labour indicators use comparable and clearly labelled periods; mixing unmatched vintages can create false divergence. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Demand: Whether India's economic recovery after COVID-19 was V-shaped.
Analysis: Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Status: Official-paper demand routed in the audited 2018-2023 GS-III ledger.
Analysis: Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status,

source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: High-frequency indicators: High-frequency indicators provide timely signals before complete national accounts, but they are partial proxies whose seasonal, base and coverage effects must be checked.

V-shaped recovery boundary: India's FY21 quarterly real-GDP path recorded a sharp contraction followed by sequential return to positive year-on-year growth, but a V-shaped aggregate path does not prove uniform sectoral or employment recovery. **FY21 revision example:** The owner distinguishes the NSO May 2021 provisional full-year FY21 contraction estimate of 7.3 percent from the January 2022 revised estimate of 6.6 percent, illustrating why estimate vintage must be retained. **Comparable-period synthesis:** Cross-box synthesis is valid only when growth, prices, fiscal, external and labour indicators use comparable and clearly labelled periods; mixing unmatched vintages can create false divergence. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2021 GS-III", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Distinguish GDP, GVA, real values and nominal values. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Claim: GDP and GVA boundary. **Named evidence/example:** GDP at market prices and GVA at basic prices answer related but distinct questions, so tax and subsidy effects can make their growth rates differ without contradiction. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Real and nominal boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Real aggregates remove price change using a stated base and method, while nominal aggregates value output at current prices; a real growth rate cannot be compared directly with a nominal level. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- GDP at market prices and GVA at basic prices answer related but distinct questions, so tax and subsidy effects can make their growth rates differ without contradiction.
- Real aggregates remove price change using a stated base and method, while nominal aggregates value output at current prices; a real growth rate cannot be compared directly with a nominal level.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: GDP and GVA boundary. **Named evidence/example:** GDP at market prices and GVA at basic prices answer related but distinct questions, so tax and subsidy effects can make their growth rates differ without contradiction. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain

the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Real and nominal boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Real aggregates remove price change using a stated base and method, while nominal aggregates value output at current prices; a real growth rate cannot be compared directly with a nominal level. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Distinguish GDP, GVA, real values and nominal values. Answer in about 150 words.", every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** GDP and GVA boundary. **Named evidence/example:** GDP at market prices and GVA at basic prices answer related but distinct questions, so tax and subsidy effects can make their growth rates differ without contradiction. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Real and nominal boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Real aggregates remove price change using a stated base and method, while nominal aggregates value output at current prices; a real growth rate cannot be compared directly with a nominal level. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** GDP at market prices and GVA at basic prices answer related but distinct questions, so tax and subsidy effects can make their growth rates differ without contradiction. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Real aggregates remove price change using a stated base and method, while nominal aggregates value output at current prices; a real growth rate cannot be compared directly with a nominal level. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** GDP and GVA boundary. **Named evidence/example:** GDP at market prices and GVA at basic prices answer related but distinct questions, so tax and subsidy effects can make their growth rates differ without contradiction. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Real and nominal boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Real aggregates remove price change using a stated base and method, while nominal aggregates value output at current prices; a real growth rate cannot be compared directly with a nominal level. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary,

and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Distinguish GDP, GVA, real values and nominal values. Answer in about 150 words.", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Why must Survey figures retain their estimate vintage and denominator? Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Claim: First Advance Estimate. **Named evidence/example:** A First Advance Estimate is released before complete annual data and is revised as fuller information arrives; it is neither a final audited outcome nor a timeless current fact. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Estimate-vintage sequence. **Named evidence/example:** National accounts move through advance, provisional and revised estimates as data improve; every quoted figure must retain the release date and estimate vintage used by the source. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Dashboard denominator. **Named evidence/example:** A dashboard indicator must preserve whether it is a level, growth rate, ratio, share, index, stock, flow or per-capita measure and identify the denominator before comparison. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Survey, Budget and outturn. **Named evidence/example:** An Economic Survey observation or projection, a Budget proposal and a subsequently reported official outturn are different evidence classes and must not be blended into one government commitment or achievement. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- A First Advance Estimate is released before complete annual data and is revised as fuller information arrives; it is neither a final audited outcome nor a timeless current fact.
- National accounts move through advance, provisional and revised estimates as data improve; every quoted figure must retain the release date and estimate vintage used by the source.
- A dashboard indicator must preserve whether it is a level, growth rate, ratio, share, index, stock, flow or per-capita measure and identify the denominator before comparison.
- An Economic Survey observation or projection, a Budget proposal and a subsequently reported official outturn are different evidence classes and must not be blended into one government commitment or achievement.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: First Advance Estimate. **Named evidence/example:** A First Advance Estimate is released before complete annual data and is revised as fuller information arrives; it is neither a final audited outcome nor a timeless current fact. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Estimate-vintage sequence. **Named evidence/example:** National accounts move through advance, provisional and revised estimates as data improve; every quoted figure must retain the release date and estimate vintage used by the source. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Dashboard denominator. **Named evidence/example:** A dashboard indicator must preserve whether it is a level, growth rate, ratio, share, index, stock, flow or per-capita measure and identify the denominator before comparison. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Survey, Budget and outturn. **Named evidence/example:** An Economic Survey observation or projection, a Budget proposal and a subsequently reported official outturn are different evidence classes and must not be blended into one government commitment or achievement. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Why must Survey figures retain their estimate vintage and denominator? Answer in about 150...", every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: First Advance Estimate. **Named evidence/example:** A First Advance Estimate is released before complete annual data and is revised as fuller information arrives; it is neither a final audited outcome nor a timeless current fact. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Estimate-vintage sequence. **Named evidence/example:** National accounts move through advance, provisional and revised estimates as data improve; every quoted figure must retain the release date and estimate vintage used by the source. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Dashboard denominator. **Named evidence/example:** A dashboard indicator must preserve whether it is a level, growth rate, ratio, share, index, stock, flow or per-capita measure and identify the denominator before comparison. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Survey, Budget and outturn. **Named evidence/example:** An Economic Survey observation or projection, a Budget proposal and a subsequently reported official outturn are different evidence classes and must not be blended into one government commitment or achievement. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal

perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** A First Advance Estimate is released before complete annual data and is revised as fuller information arrives; it is neither a final audited outcome nor a timeless current fact. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
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3. **Claim and named evidence:** A dashboard indicator must preserve whether it is a level, growth rate, ratio, share, index, stock, flow or per-capita measure and identify the denominator before comparison. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** An Economic Survey observation or projection, a Budget proposal and a subsequently reported official outturn are different evidence classes and must not be blended into one government commitment or achievement. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** First Advance Estimate. **Named evidence/example:** A First Advance Estimate is released before complete annual data and is revised as fuller information arrives; it is neither a final audited outcome nor a timeless current fact. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Estimate-vintage sequence. **Named evidence/example:** National accounts move through advance, provisional and revised estimates as data improve; every quoted figure must retain the release date and estimate vintage used by the source. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Dashboard denominator. **Named evidence/example:** A dashboard indicator must preserve whether it is a level, growth rate, ratio, share, index, stock, flow or per-capita measure and identify the denominator before comparison. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Survey, Budget and outturn. **Named evidence/example:** An Economic Survey observation or projection, a Budget proposal and a subsequently reported official outturn are different evidence classes and must not be blended into one government commitment or achievement. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base

year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Why must Survey figures retain their estimate vintage and denominator? Answer in about 150...", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Build a six-box framework for assessing macro stability. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Claim: BE, RE and actual. **Named evidence/example:** Budget Estimate is a forward plan, Revised Estimate is an in-year reassessment and CGA provisional or final accounts report realised fiscal flows; proposal, revision and outturn are not interchangeable. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Headline and core inflation. **Named evidence/example:** Headline CPI includes food and fuel while core measures exclude selected volatile components; low headline inflation does not mean every component or household basket became cheaper. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Reserve stock and CAD flow. **Named evidence/example:** Foreign-exchange reserves are a point-in-time stock, while the current-account balance is a period flow; a large stock buffer does not by itself correct a persistent flow imbalance. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** PLFS method boundary. **Named evidence/example:** PLFS labour indicators depend on period, geography and status concept such as usual status or current weekly status; one rate without its denominator and method is incomplete. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Macro-stability frame. **Named evidence/example:** Macro stability combines manageable inflation, fiscal credibility, external resilience and financial soundness; one strong growth headline cannot establish stability across all boxes. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Budget Estimate is a forward plan, Revised Estimate is an in-year reassessment and CGA provisional or final accounts report realised fiscal flows; proposal, revision and outturn are not interchangeable.

- Headline CPI includes food and fuel while core measures exclude selected volatile components; low headline inflation does not mean every component or household basket became cheaper.
- Foreign-exchange reserves are a point-in-time stock, while the current-account balance is a period flow; a large stock buffer does not by itself correct a persistent flow imbalance.
- PLFS labour indicators depend on period, geography and status concept such as usual status or current weekly status; one rate without its denominator and method is incomplete.
- Macro stability combines manageable inflation, fiscal credibility, external resilience and financial soundness; one strong growth headline cannot establish stability across all boxes.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: BE, RE and actual. **Named evidence/example:** Budget Estimate is a forward plan, Revised Estimate is an in-year reassessment and CGA provisional or final accounts report realised fiscal flows; proposal, revision and outturn are not interchangeable. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Headline and core inflation. **Named evidence/example:** Headline CPI includes food and fuel while core measures exclude selected volatile components; low headline inflation does not mean every component or household basket became cheaper. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Reserve stock and CAD flow. **Named evidence/example:** Foreign-exchange reserves are a point-in-time stock, while the current-account balance is a period flow; a large stock buffer does not by itself correct a persistent flow imbalance. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** PLFS method boundary. **Named evidence/example:** PLFS labour indicators depend on period, geography and status concept such as usual status or current weekly status; one rate without its denominator and method is incomplete. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Macro-stability frame. **Named evidence/example:** Macro stability combines manageable inflation, fiscal credibility, external resilience and financial soundness; one strong growth headline cannot establish stability across all boxes. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Build a six-box framework for assessing macro stability. Answer in about 250 words.", every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: BE, RE and actual. **Named evidence/example:** Budget Estimate is a forward plan, Revised Estimate is an in-year reassessment and CGA provisional or final accounts report realised fiscal flows; proposal, revision and outturn are not interchangeable. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Headline and core inflation. **Named evidence/example:** Headline CPI includes food and fuel while core measures exclude selected volatile components; low headline inflation does not mean every component or household basket became cheaper. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant

institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Reserve stock and CAD flow. **Named evidence/example:** Foreign-exchange reserves are a point-in-time stock, while the current-account balance is a period flow; a large stock buffer does not by itself correct a persistent flow imbalance. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** PLFS method boundary. **Named evidence/example:** PLFS labour indicators depend on period, geography and status concept such as usual status or current weekly status; one rate without its denominator and method is incomplete. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Macro-stability frame. **Named evidence/example:** Macro stability combines manageable inflation, fiscal credibility, external resilience and financial soundness; one strong growth headline cannot establish stability across all boxes. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Budget Estimate is a forward plan, Revised Estimate is an in-year reassessment and CGA provisional or final accounts report realised fiscal flows; proposal, revision and outturn are not interchangeable. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Headline CPI includes food and fuel while core measures exclude selected volatile components; low headline inflation does not mean every component or household basket became cheaper. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Foreign-exchange reserves are a point-in-time stock, while the current-account balance is a period flow; a large stock buffer does not by itself correct a persistent flow imbalance. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** PLFS labour indicators depend on period, geography and status concept such as usual status or current weekly status; one rate without its denominator and method is incomplete. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Macro stability combines manageable inflation, fiscal credibility, external resilience and financial soundness; one strong growth headline cannot establish stability across all boxes. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: BE, RE and actual. **Named evidence/example:** Budget Estimate is a forward plan, Revised Estimate is an in-year reassessment and CGA provisional or final accounts report realised fiscal flows; proposal, revision and outturn are not interchangeable. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Headline and core inflation. **Named evidence/example:** Headline CPI includes food and fuel while core measures exclude selected volatile components; low headline inflation does not mean every component or household basket became cheaper. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Reserve stock and CAD flow. **Named evidence/example:** Foreign-exchange reserves are a point-in-time stock, while the current-account balance is a period flow; a large stock buffer does not by itself correct a persistent flow imbalance. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** PLFS method boundary. **Named evidence/example:** PLFS labour indicators depend on period, geography and status concept such as usual status or current weekly status; one rate without its denominator and method is incomplete. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Macro-stability frame. **Named evidence/example:** Macro stability combines manageable inflation, fiscal credibility, external resilience and financial soundness; one strong growth headline cannot establish stability across all boxes. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Build a six-box framework for assessing macro stability. Answer in about 250 words.", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Assess the claim that India's post-COVID recovery was V-shaped. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** High-frequency indicators. **Named evidence/example:** High-frequency indicators provide timely signals before complete national accounts, but they are partial proxies whose seasonal, base and coverage effects must be checked. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** V-shaped recovery boundary. **Named evidence/example:** India's FY21 quarterly real-GDP path recorded a sharp contraction followed by sequential return to positive year-on-year growth, but a V-shaped aggregate path does not prove uniform sectoral or employment recovery. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** FY21 revision example. **Named evidence/example:** The owner distinguishes the NSO May 2021 provisional full-year FY21 contraction estimate of 7.3 percent from the January 2022 revised estimate of 6.6 percent, illustrating why estimate vintage must be retained. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Comparable-period synthesis. **Named evidence/example:** Cross-box synthesis is valid only when growth, prices, fiscal, external and labour indicators use comparable and clearly labelled periods; mixing unmatched vintages can create false divergence. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- High-frequency indicators provide timely signals before complete national accounts, but they are partial proxies whose seasonal, base and coverage effects must be checked.
- India's FY21 quarterly real-GDP path recorded a sharp contraction followed by sequential return to positive year-on-year growth, but a V-shaped aggregate path does not prove uniform sectoral or employment recovery.
- The owner distinguishes the NSO May 2021 provisional full-year FY21 contraction estimate of 7.3 percent from the January 2022 revised estimate of 6.6 percent, illustrating why estimate vintage must be retained.
- Cross-box synthesis is valid only when growth, prices, fiscal, external and labour indicators use comparable and clearly labelled periods; mixing unmatched vintages can create false divergence.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** High-frequency indicators. **Named evidence/example:** High-frequency indicators provide timely signals before complete national accounts, but they are partial proxies whose seasonal, base and coverage effects must be checked. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** V-shaped recovery boundary. **Named evidence/example:** India's FY21 quarterly real-GDP path recorded a sharp contraction followed by sequential return to positive year-on-year growth, but a V-shaped aggregate path does not prove uniform sectoral or employment recovery. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** FY21 revision example. **Named evidence/example:** The owner distinguishes the NSO May 2021 provisional full-year FY21 contraction estimate of 7.3 percent from the January 2022 revised estimate of 6.6 percent, illustrating why estimate vintage must be retained. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The

conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Comparable-period synthesis. **Named evidence/example:** Cross-box synthesis is valid only when growth, prices, fiscal, external and labour indicators use comparable and clearly labelled periods; mixing unmatched vintages can create false divergence. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Demand decoding: The directive **assess** requires a direct position on "Assess the claim that India's post-COVID recovery was V-shaped. Answer in about 250 words.", every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** High-frequency indicators. **Named evidence/example:** High-frequency indicators provide timely signals before complete national accounts, but they are partial proxies whose seasonal, base and coverage effects must be checked. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** V-shaped recovery boundary. **Named evidence/example:** India's FY21 quarterly real-GDP path recorded a sharp contraction followed by sequential return to positive year-on-year growth, but a V-shaped aggregate path does not prove uniform sectoral or employment recovery. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** FY21 revision example. **Named evidence/example:** The owner distinguishes the NSO May 2021 provisional full-year FY21 contraction estimate of 7.3 percent from the January 2022 revised estimate of 6.6 percent, illustrating why estimate vintage must be retained. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Comparable-period synthesis. **Named evidence/example:** Cross-box synthesis is valid only when growth, prices, fiscal, external and labour indicators use comparable and clearly labelled periods; mixing unmatched vintages can create false divergence. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** High-frequency indicators provide timely signals before complete national accounts, but they are partial proxies whose seasonal, base and coverage effects must be checked. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** India's FY21 quarterly real-GDP path recorded a sharp contraction followed by sequential return to positive year-on-year growth, but a V-shaped aggregate path does not prove uniform sectoral or employment recovery. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** The owner distinguishes the NSO May 2021 provisional full-year FY21 contraction estimate of 7.3 percent from the January 2022 revised estimate of 6.6 percent, illustrating why estimate vintage must be retained. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Cross-box synthesis is valid only when growth, prices, fiscal, external and labour indicators use comparable and clearly labelled periods; mixing unmatched vintages can create false divergence. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: High-frequency indicators. **Named evidence/example:** High-frequency indicators provide timely signals before complete national accounts, but they are partial proxies whose seasonal, base and coverage effects must be checked. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** V-shaped recovery boundary. **Named evidence/example:** India's FY21 quarterly real-GDP path recorded a sharp contraction followed by sequential return to positive year-on-year growth, but a V-shaped aggregate path does not prove uniform sectoral or employment recovery. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** FY21 revision example. **Named evidence/example:** The owner distinguishes the NSO May 2021 provisional full-year FY21 contraction estimate of 7.3 percent from the January 2022 revised estimate of 6.6 percent, illustrating why estimate vintage must be retained. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Comparable-period synthesis. **Named evidence/example:** Cross-box synthesis is valid only when growth, prices, fiscal, external and labour indicators use comparable and clearly labelled periods; mixing unmatched vintages can create false divergence. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Assess the claim that India's post-COVID recovery was V-shaped. Answer in about 250 words.", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Explain how to synthesise growth, inflation, fiscal, external and employment indicators without mixing vintages. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** Demand composition. **Named evidence/example:** PFCE, government consumption, gross capital formation and net exports describe expenditure composition; a component's share of GDP and its growth rate are different measures. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** BE, RE and actual. **Named evidence/example:** Budget Estimate is a forward plan, Revised Estimate is an in-year reassessment and CGA provisional or final accounts report realised fiscal flows; proposal, revision and outturn are not interchangeable. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Headline and core inflation. **Named evidence/example:** Headline CPI includes food and fuel while core measures exclude selected volatile components; low headline inflation does not mean every component or household basket became cheaper. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Reserve stock and CAD flow. **Named evidence/example:** Foreign-exchange reserves are a point-in-time stock, while the current-account balance is a period flow; a large stock buffer does not by itself correct a persistent flow imbalance. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** PLFS method boundary. **Named evidence/example:** PLFS labour indicators depend on period, geography and status concept such as usual status or current weekly status; one rate without its denominator and method is incomplete. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Dashboard denominator. **Named evidence/example:** A dashboard indicator must preserve whether it is a level, growth rate, ratio, share, index, stock, flow or per-capita measure and identify the denominator before comparison. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Comparable-period synthesis. **Named evidence/example:** Cross-box synthesis is valid only when growth, prices, fiscal, external and labour indicators use comparable and clearly labelled periods; mixing unmatched vintages can create false divergence. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- PFCE, government consumption, gross capital formation and net exports describe expenditure composition; a component's share of GDP and its growth rate are different measures.
- Budget Estimate is a forward plan, Revised Estimate is an in-year reassessment and CGA provisional or final accounts report realised fiscal flows; proposal, revision and outturn are not interchangeable.
- Headline CPI includes food and fuel while core measures exclude selected volatile components; low headline inflation does not mean every component or household basket became cheaper.

- Foreign-exchange reserves are a point-in-time stock, while the current-account balance is a period flow; a large stock buffer does not by itself correct a persistent flow imbalance.
- PLFS labour indicators depend on period, geography and status concept such as usual status or current weekly status; one rate without its denominator and method is incomplete.
- A dashboard indicator must preserve whether it is a level, growth rate, ratio, share, index, stock, flow or per-capita measure and identify the denominator before comparison.
- Cross-box synthesis is valid only when growth, prices, fiscal, external and labour indicators use comparable and clearly labelled periods; mixing unmatched vintages can create false divergence.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Demand composition. **Named evidence/example:** PFCE, government consumption, gross capital formation and net exports describe expenditure composition; a component's share of GDP and its growth rate are different measures. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** BE, RE and actual. **Named evidence/example:** Budget Estimate is a forward plan, Revised Estimate is an in-year reassessment and CGA provisional or final accounts report realised fiscal flows; proposal, revision and outturn are not interchangeable. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Headline and core inflation. **Named evidence/example:** Headline CPI includes food and fuel while core measures exclude selected volatile components; low headline inflation does not mean every component or household basket became cheaper. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Reserve stock and CAD flow. **Named evidence/example:** Foreign-exchange reserves are a point-in-time stock, while the current-account balance is a period flow; a large stock buffer does not by itself correct a persistent flow imbalance. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** PLFS method boundary. **Named evidence/example:** PLFS labour indicators depend on period, geography and status concept such as usual status or current weekly status; one rate without its denominator and method is incomplete. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Dashboard denominator. **Named evidence/example:** A dashboard indicator must preserve whether it is a level, growth rate, ratio, share, index, stock, flow or per-capita measure and identify the denominator before comparison. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Comparable-period synthesis. **Named evidence/example:** Cross-box synthesis is valid only when growth, prices, fiscal, external and labour indicators use comparable and clearly labelled periods; mixing unmatched vintages can create false divergence. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Demand decoding: The directive **explain** requires a direct position on "Explain how to synthesise growth, inflation, fiscal, external and employment indicators...", every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects,

trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** Demand composition. **Named evidence/example:** PFCE, government consumption, gross capital formation and net exports describe expenditure composition; a component's share of GDP and its growth rate are different measures. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** BE, RE and actual. **Named evidence/example:** Budget Estimate is a forward plan, Revised Estimate is an in-year reassessment and CGA provisional or final accounts report realised fiscal flows; proposal, revision and outturn are not interchangeable. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Headline and core inflation. **Named evidence/example:** Headline CPI includes food and fuel while core measures exclude selected volatile components; low headline inflation does not mean every component or household basket became cheaper. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Reserve stock and CAD flow. **Named evidence/example:** Foreign-exchange reserves are a point-in-time stock, while the current-account balance is a period flow; a large stock buffer does not by itself correct a persistent flow imbalance. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** PLFS method boundary. **Named evidence/example:** PLFS labour indicators depend on period, geography and status concept such as usual status or current weekly status; one rate without its denominator and method is incomplete. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Dashboard denominator. **Named evidence/example:** A dashboard indicator must preserve whether it is a level, growth rate, ratio, share, index, stock, flow or per-capita measure and identify the denominator before comparison. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Comparable-period synthesis. **Named evidence/example:** Cross-box synthesis is valid only when growth, prices, fiscal, external and labour indicators use comparable and clearly labelled periods; mixing unmatched vintages can create false divergence. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** PFCE, government consumption, gross capital formation and net exports describe expenditure composition; a component's share of GDP and its growth rate are different measures. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Budget Estimate is a forward plan, Revised Estimate is an in-year reassessment and CGA provisional or final accounts report realised fiscal flows; proposal, revision and outturn are not

interchangeable. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** Headline CPI includes food and fuel while core measures exclude selected volatile components; low headline inflation does not mean every component or household basket became cheaper.

Analysis: Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** Foreign-exchange reserves are a point-in-time stock, while the current-account balance is a period flow; a large stock buffer does not by itself correct a persistent flow imbalance. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect.

Qualification: State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

5. **Claim and named evidence:** PLFS labour indicators depend on period, geography and status concept such as usual status or current weekly status; one rate without its denominator and method is incomplete. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect.

Qualification: State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

6. **Claim and named evidence:** A dashboard indicator must preserve whether it is a level, growth rate, ratio, share, index, stock, flow or per-capita measure and identify the denominator before comparison. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect.

Qualification: State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

7. **Claim and named evidence:** Cross-box synthesis is valid only when growth, prices, fiscal, external and labour indicators use comparable and clearly labelled periods; mixing unmatched vintages can create false divergence.

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Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Demand composition. **Named evidence/example:** PFCE, government consumption, gross capital formation and net exports describe expenditure composition; a component's share of GDP and its growth rate are different measures. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** BE, RE and actual. **Named evidence/example:** Budget Estimate is a forward plan, Revised Estimate is an in-year reassessment and CGA provisional or final accounts report realised fiscal flows; proposal, revision and outturn are not interchangeable. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Headline and core inflation. **Named evidence/example:** Headline CPI includes food and fuel while core measures exclude selected volatile components; low headline inflation does not mean every component or household basket became cheaper. **Analysis:**

This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Reserve stock and CAD flow. **Named evidence/example:** Foreign-exchange reserves are a point-in-time stock, while the current-account balance is a period flow; a large stock buffer does not by itself correct a persistent flow imbalance. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** PLFS method boundary. **Named evidence/example:** PLFS labour indicators depend on period, geography and status concept such as usual status or current weekly status; one rate without its denominator and method is incomplete. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Dashboard denominator. **Named evidence/example:** A dashboard indicator must preserve whether it is a level, growth rate, ratio, share, index, stock, flow or per-capita measure and identify the denominator before comparison. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Comparable-period synthesis. **Named evidence/example:** Cross-box synthesis is valid only when growth, prices, fiscal, external and labour indicators use comparable and clearly labelled periods; mixing unmatched vintages can create false divergence. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Explain how to synthesise growth, inflation, fiscal, external and employment indicators...", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Evaluate the Economic Survey as a diagnostic guide rather than a record of final outcomes. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** First Advance Estimate. **Named evidence/example:** A First Advance Estimate is released before complete annual data and is revised as fuller information arrives; it is neither a final audited outcome nor a timeless current fact. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Estimate-vintage sequence. **Named evidence/example:** National accounts move through advance, provisional and revised estimates as data improve; every quoted figure must retain the release date and estimate vintage used by the source. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the

effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** High-frequency indicators. **Named evidence/example:** High-frequency indicators provide timely signals before complete national accounts, but they are partial proxies whose seasonal, base and coverage effects must be checked. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Survey, Budget and outturn. **Named evidence/example:** An Economic Survey observation or projection, a Budget proposal and a subsequently reported official outturn are different evidence classes and must not be blended into one government commitment or achievement. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Forecast and potential growth. **Named evidence/example:** A near-term forecast is conditional on assumptions and a data vintage, while potential growth is an assessment of sustainable capacity; neither is an achieved growth rate. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Macro-stability frame. **Named evidence/example:** Macro stability combines manageable inflation, fiscal credibility, external resilience and financial soundness; one strong growth headline cannot establish stability across all boxes. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Strategic resilience and indispensability. **Named evidence/example:** Strategic resilience is the capacity to absorb shocks, while strategic indispensability is the capacity to become a reliable valuable node in global systems; buffers alone do not create productive capability. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- A First Advance Estimate is released before complete annual data and is revised as fuller information arrives; it is neither a final audited outcome nor a timeless current fact.
- National accounts move through advance, provisional and revised estimates as data improve; every quoted figure must retain the release date and estimate vintage used by the source.
- High-frequency indicators provide timely signals before complete national accounts, but they are partial proxies whose seasonal, base and coverage effects must be checked.
- An Economic Survey observation or projection, a Budget proposal and a subsequently reported official outturn are different evidence classes and must not be blended into one government commitment or achievement.
- A near-term forecast is conditional on assumptions and a data vintage, while potential growth is an assessment of sustainable capacity; neither is an achieved growth rate.
- Macro stability combines manageable inflation, fiscal credibility, external resilience and financial soundness; one strong growth headline cannot establish stability across all boxes.
- Strategic resilience is the capacity to absorb shocks, while strategic indispensability is the capacity to become a reliable valuable node in global systems; buffers alone do not create productive capability.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** First Advance Estimate. **Named evidence/example:** A First Advance Estimate is released before complete annual data and is revised as fuller information arrives; it is neither a final audited outcome nor a timeless current fact. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting

boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Estimate-vintage sequence. **Named evidence/example:** National accounts move through advance, provisional and revised estimates as data improve; every quoted figure must retain the release date and estimate vintage used by the source. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** High-frequency indicators. **Named evidence/example:** High-frequency indicators provide timely signals before complete national accounts, but they are partial proxies whose seasonal, base and coverage effects must be checked. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Survey, Budget and outturn. **Named evidence/example:** An Economic Survey observation or projection, a Budget proposal and a subsequently reported official outturn are different evidence classes and must not be blended into one government commitment or achievement. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Forecast and potential growth. **Named evidence/example:** A near-term forecast is conditional on assumptions and a data vintage, while potential growth is an assessment of sustainable capacity; neither is an achieved growth rate. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Macro-stability frame. **Named evidence/example:** Macro stability combines manageable inflation, fiscal credibility, external resilience and financial soundness; one strong growth headline cannot establish stability across all boxes. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Strategic resilience and indispensability. **Named evidence/example:** Strategic resilience is the capacity to absorb shocks, while strategic indispensability is the capacity to become a reliable valuable node in global systems; buffers alone do not create productive capability. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Demand decoding: The directive **evaluate** requires a direct position on "Evaluate the Economic Survey as a diagnostic guide rather than a record of final outcomes....", every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** First Advance Estimate. **Named evidence/example:** A First Advance Estimate is released before complete annual data and is revised as fuller information arrives; it is neither a final audited outcome nor a timeless current fact. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Estimate-vintage sequence. **Named evidence/example:** National accounts move through advance, provisional and revised estimates as data improve; every quoted figure must retain the release date and estimate vintage used by the

source. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** High-frequency indicators. **Named evidence/example:** High-frequency indicators provide timely signals before complete national accounts, but they are partial proxies whose seasonal, base and coverage effects must be checked. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Survey, Budget and outturn. **Named evidence/example:** An Economic Survey observation or projection, a Budget proposal and a subsequently reported official outturn are different evidence classes and must not be blended into one government commitment or achievement. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Forecast and potential growth. **Named evidence/example:** A near-term forecast is conditional on assumptions and a data vintage, while potential growth is an assessment of sustainable capacity; neither is an achieved growth rate. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Macro-stability frame. **Named evidence/example:** Macro stability combines manageable inflation, fiscal credibility, external resilience and financial soundness; one strong growth headline cannot establish stability across all boxes. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Strategic resilience and indispensability. **Named evidence/example:** Strategic resilience is the capacity to absorb shocks, while strategic indispensability is the capacity to become a reliable valuable node in global systems; buffers alone do not create productive capability. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** A First Advance Estimate is released before complete annual data and is revised as fuller information arrives; it is neither a final audited outcome nor a timeless current fact. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** National accounts move through advance, provisional and revised estimates as data improve; every quoted figure must retain the release date and estimate vintage used by the source. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** High-frequency indicators provide timely signals before complete national accounts, but they are partial proxies whose seasonal, base and coverage effects must be checked. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status,

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7. **Claim and named evidence:** Strategic resilience is the capacity to absorb shocks, while strategic indispensability is the capacity to become a reliable valuable node in global systems; buffers alone do not create productive capability. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: First Advance Estimate. **Named evidence/example:** A First Advance Estimate is released before complete annual data and is revised as fuller information arrives; it is neither a final audited outcome nor a timeless current fact. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Estimate-vintage sequence. **Named evidence/example:** National accounts move through advance, provisional and revised estimates as data improve; every quoted figure must retain the release date and estimate vintage used by the source. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** High-frequency indicators. **Named evidence/example:** High-frequency indicators provide timely signals before complete national accounts, but they are partial proxies whose seasonal, base and coverage effects must be checked. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Survey, Budget and outturn. **Named evidence/example:** An Economic Survey observation or projection, a Budget proposal and a subsequently reported official outturn are different evidence classes and must not be blended into one government commitment or achievement. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal

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Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Evaluate the Economic Survey as a diagnostic guide rather than a record of final outcomes....", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.